

HOW TO TALK ABOUT YOUR HOMETOWN

IN IELTS SPEAKING

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About the Author

Keith runs The Keith Speaking Academy. He has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.



In this PDF I will show you some advanced vocabulary and natural English to impress the IELTS examiner when you talk about your hometown.

You will learn:

1. What to Talk About

2. Useful Vocabulary and Grammar

Also, I will show you how to combine basic vocabulary with some advanced phrases.

One of the secrets to succeeding in IELTS Speaking is to use natural, spoken English.

You should avoid

- **too much overcomplicated vocabulary,**
- **poetic vocabulary**
- **clichés or overused phrases**

What To Talk About

In part 1 you are asked direct questions, but if you get the topic of hometown in part 2, you can talk about any of the following:

1. **How long you have lived there**
2. **Size**
3. **Location**
4. **What it is famous for**
5. **People**
6. **What you can do there**
7. **Your likes and dislikes**
8. **Changes**



1. How Long You Have Lived There

- I come from {country} and I was **born and bred** in {hometown}
- I was **brought up** in {hometown}
- I was **raised** in {hometown}

*I come from England and I was **born and bred** in Manchester*

*I was **brought up** in Manchester*

*I was **raised** in Manchester*

To be born and bred = to be born and raised (in a place)

Grammar Point

If you still live in your hometown, you can use the present perfect and / or the present perfect continuous

- **I've lived here** for 20 years
- **I've been living** here for 20 years

A nice expression is '**odd + number**' which in this context means 'approximately'.

Note, this is only used for larger numbers like 20, 30, 40 and so on.

*I've been living here **for 20 odd years***

Another nice expression is '**for the best part of**' which in this context means 'most of that time'.

*I've been living here **for the best part of 5 years***

Grammar Point

If you no longer live there, you should use the **simple past**

- *I lived there for **20 odd years** and then moved to London*
- *I lived there **for the best part of 20 years** and then moved to London*

2. Size

Of course, you can use simple adjectives to describe size, such as,

- *It's a **small** town*
- *I live in a **big** city*

However, you can also make this more impressive by using simple **adverbs** to describe those adjectives.

Here are some examples:

- *It's a **pretty** small town*
- *It's a **fairly** little village*
- *It's a **somewhat** small city*
- *It's a **really** big city*

You can also use more emphatic adjectives like the following:

It's a **vast** city (=very big)

It's a **sprawling** city (=spread over a large area)

3. Location



- **It's in the north of {country}**
- **It's in the centre of {country}**

Manchester is in the north of England

Notice if you describe location in relation to another city, we would say,

- **It is north/south/east/west OF {big city}**

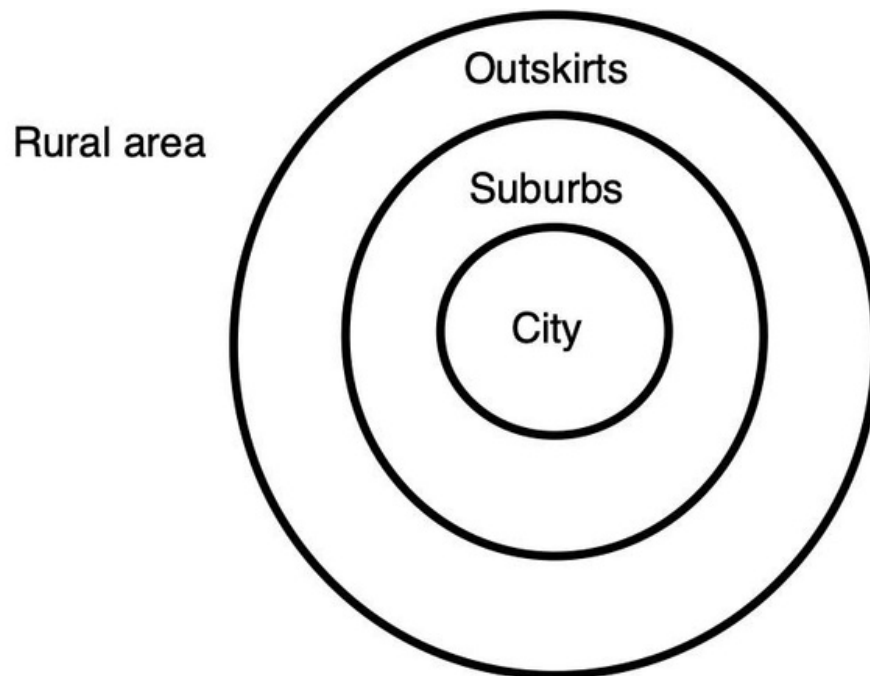
For example,

- *Manchester is **north of** London*
- *Cambridge is just **north of** London*
- *It's about 50 odd miles **north of** London*

Talking about being located in different areas, we can also say,

- *It's **on the coast***
- *It's located **in a rural area***
- *It's a small town **in the suburbs** of {big city}*
- *It's **in / on the outskirts** of {city}*
- *It is / sits **on the river***
- *It is / sits **in the green belt***

A green belt is an area where the government tries to preserve green spaces.



4. What it is Famous For



Your hometown, like any city, maybe famous for number of things including,

- **Food**
- **Cultural events**
- **Language or accent**
- **Industry**
- **Sport**
- **Weather**
- **Celebrities**

It's famous for its_____

It's well-known for its_____

It's best-known for its_____

Manchester is **well-known for** its university but it is probably **best-known for** its football teams.

To **flock** = to move in crowds

To be **drawn** by = to be attracted by

Prominent (adj.) = famous, important

- **Tourists flock here/there to see {famous landmark/activity}**
- **Visitors are drawn by {famous landmark/activity}**
- **The most prominent landmark is {landmark}**

Tourists **flock** to London to see the Tower Bridge

Visitors are **drawn** by the wide range of restaurants

One of the most **prominent** landmarks is Buckingham Palace

What if your town is not famous for anything?

No problem, you can just say so. Use phrases like these:

*It's a fairly **anonymous** place*

Anonymous (adj.) = unknown (adj.)

*It's **nothing to write home about***

This last expression means this thing is nothing special.

In terms of things to do there, we can say,

- **Locals tend to {activity}**
- **Locals typically {activity}**

*Locals tend **to go** shopping and eat out in the numerous restaurants*

*Locals **typically** go for a walk in the evening before dinner*

Or, if it is a very quiet place, with nothing special to do, you can say,

*There's not much **to get up to**.*

To **get up to** = to do

5. People



The local people are **friendly** and **welcoming**

- **A lot of people work in the {name of a local industry} industry**

*A lot of people **work in the fishing industry***

Here is a nice adjective you can use to say that this place is good for certain kinds of people.

It's a ____ -friendly place

- It's a pedestrian-friendly place
- It's a kid-friendly place
- It's a visitor-friendly place

*It's a **tourist-friendly place** because there is a great tourist information office, and on top of that, there is a hop-on, hop-off bus so you can take that and see all the famous landmarks in one day*

6. Changes

Grammar Point

To describe changes we often use the **present perfect**

Subject + have + Past Participle

- *It **has changed** a lot*
- *It **hasn't changed** at all*
- *The skyline **hasn't changed** in years*

More Vocabulary

To **crop up** = to appear

- **New {buildings/places} have cropped up all over the city**

Another, although more complex, expression you can use is this one:

- **There's not a day goes by without {event}**

This means this event always happens. For example,

*There's not a day goes by without a new shopping mall cropping up.
There's not a day goes by without a new restaurant appearing.*

7. My Hometown



I come from England and **I was born and bred** in Manchester.

I lived there for **20 odd years** before moving out to go to University in Sheffield.

Manchester's a **pretty big** city, **in the north of** England,

yeah, it's about a 2-hour train ride from London.

Actually the place where I am from isn't **in the centre of** Manchester,

I actually grew up in small town **in the outskirts** of Manchester.

That town isn't really famous for anything, but Manchester is.

It's famous for its University

The campus has some **prominent, historical** buildings.

It's **best-known for** its football

There are two, at least two, big football teams in Manchester.

You **get the tourists flocking** to see Old Trafford and The Etihad stadiums.

Whilst there is loads to do in Manchester, in the town where I was raised, well there's **not much to get up to**, if the truth be told.

The **local people** are quite **friendly**, I guess, but I think everybody just minds their own business.

I recently went back to Manchester, and I hardly recognised the city centre.

The **skyline has changed** so much.

Restaurants **have cropped up** left, right and centre.

It's still a nice place.

So, that's the city where **I grew up**.

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